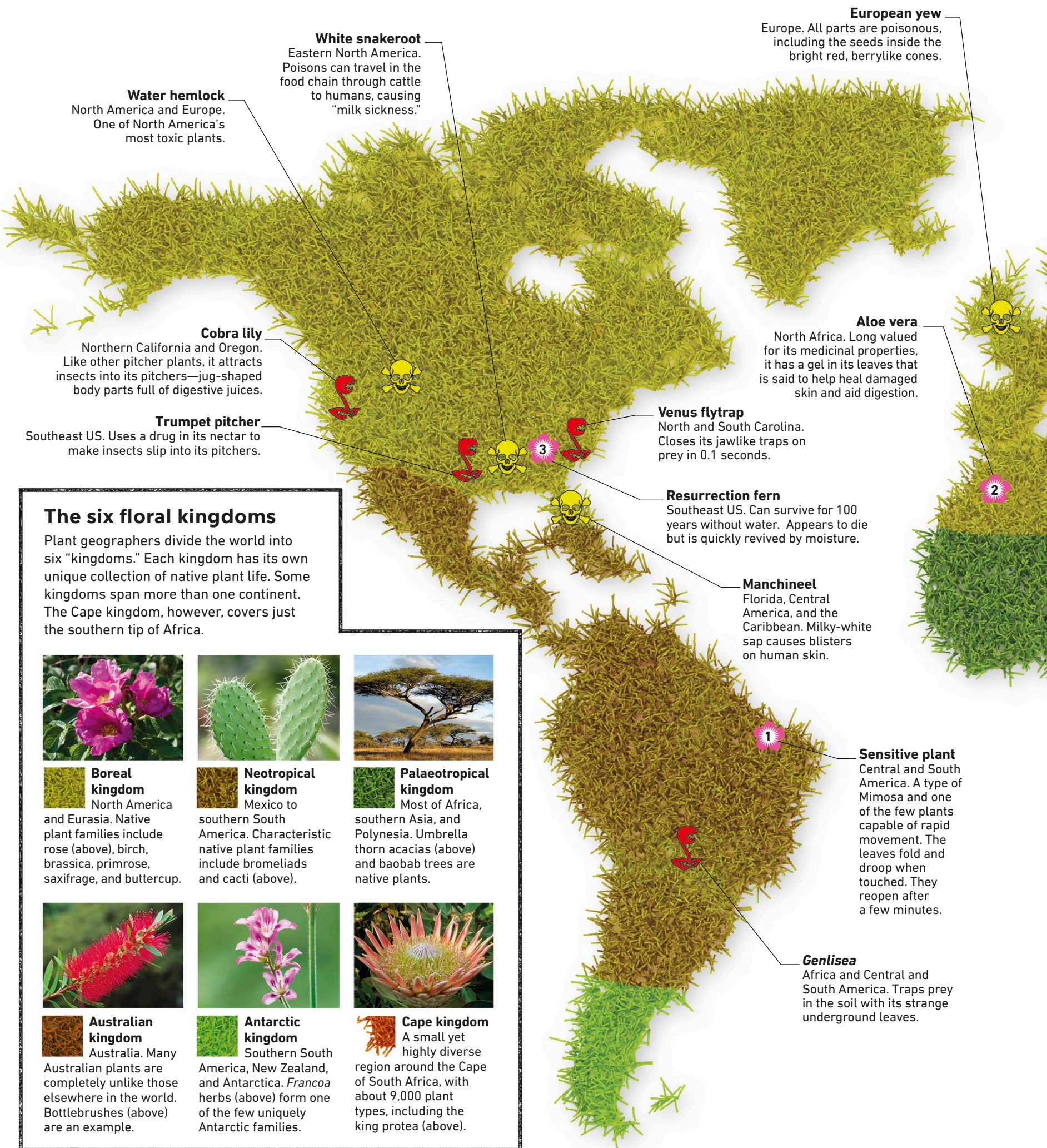




European yew

Europe. All parts are poisonous, including the seeds inside the bright red, berrylike cones.

White snakeroot

Eastern North America. Poisons can travel in the food chain through cattle to humans, causing "milk sickness."

Water hemlock

North America and Europe. One of North America's most toxic plants.

Cobra lily

Northern California and Oregon. Like other pitcher plants, it attracts insects into its pitchers—jug-shaped body parts full of digestive juices.

Trumpet pitcher

Southeast US. Uses a drug in its nectar to make insects slip into its pitchers.

Aloe vera

North Africa. Long valued for its medicinal properties, it has a gel in its leaves that is said to help heal damaged skin and aid digestion.

Venus flytrap

North and South Carolina. Closes its jawlike traps on prey in 0.1 seconds.

Resurrection fern

Southeast US. Can survive for 100 years without water. Appears to die but is quickly revived by moisture.

Manchineel

Florida, Central America, and the Caribbean. Milky-white sap causes blisters on human skin.

Sensitive plant

Central and South America. A type of Mimosa and one of the few plants capable of rapid movement. The leaves fold and droop when touched. They reopen after a few minutes.

Genlisea

Africa and Central and South America. Traps prey in the soil with its strange underground leaves.

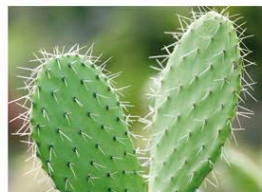
The six floral kingdoms

Plant geographers divide the world into six "kingdoms." Each kingdom has its own unique collection of native plant life. Some kingdoms span more than one continent. The Cape kingdom, however, covers just the southern tip of Africa.



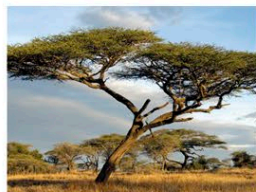
Boreal kingdom

North America and Eurasia. Native plant families include rose (above), birch, brassica, primrose, saxifrage, and buttercup.



Neotropical kingdom

Mexico to southern South America. Characteristic native plant families include bromeliads and cacti (above).



Palaeotropical kingdom

Most of Africa, southern Asia, and Polynesia. Umbrella thorn acacias (above) and baobab trees are native plants.



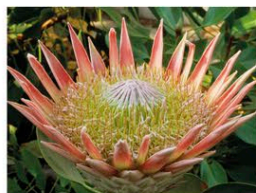
Australian kingdom

Australia. Many Australian plants are completely unlike those elsewhere in the world. Bottlebrushes (above) are an example.



Antarctic kingdom

Southern South America, New Zealand, and Antarctica. *Francoa* herbs (above) form one of the few uniquely Antarctic families.



Cape kingdom

A small yet highly diverse region around the Cape of South Africa, with about 9,000 plant types, including the king protea (above).